

Option P2: British America, 1713–83: empire and revolution

Key topic 1: British settlement in North America, 1713–41

1 Developments in colonial society	• The impact of expansion and immigration on society: the pattern of settlement and tensions among social groups. • Economic developments: trade with Britain and with the West Indies, the importance of tobacco, the impact of piracy, including the activities of 'Black Sam' Bellamy and Edward Teach ('Blackbeard'). • The suppression of piracy in American waters: King George I's Proclamation and the Piracy Act (1717), the work of Governor Spotswood.
2 Slavery in North America	• The transatlantic slave trade and 'Atlantic trade triangle'. • The impact of slavery on the development of tobacco and rice plantations. • The impact of slavery on colonial society; the position of enslaved people within society and the treatment of fugitives within the colonies.
3 Problems within the colonies	• Slave revolts in the Carolinas: the Stono Rebellion (1739); the significance of Spain's decision to protect runaways in Florida. • The New York Conspiracy (1741). • Smuggling, attempts to collect customs revenue and to control the fur trade.

Key topic 2: A disrupted society, 1742–64

1 The impact of cultural developments	• Religious revivals, including the Great Awakening and revivalist preachers. • The Enlightenment: the emphasis on education; the growth of newspapers and public libraries. • The significance of Benjamin Franklin as a writer, philanthropist and intellectual.
2 War in the colonies	• Relations with the French and with Indigenous peoples during and after King George's War (1744–48). • The French and Indian War (1754–63) in North America and the role of Wolfe in Canada. • The significance of the Treaty of Paris (1763) and the Proclamation Act (1763).
3 The aftermath of the French and Indian war	• The impact of the war on American colonists' relations with Britain. • Opposition to the Sugar Act (1764). • Relations with Indigenous peoples, including Pontiac's Rebellion (1763–64). The Paxton Boys: their actions and impact.

Key topic 3: The loss of an empire, 1765–83

1 American colonist relations with Britain: growing opposition, 1765-75	• Opposition to British policies: the Stamp Act, the Sons of Liberty and the Boston Massacre (1770). • British and American relations: the Boston Tea Party (1773) and the Intolerable Acts (1774). • The significance of the First and Second Continental Congresses, 1774–75.
2 The War of Independence 1775-83	• The influence of Thomas Paine's 'Common Sense'. The significance of the Declaration of Independence. The role of Thomas Jefferson. • Key American victories: Saratoga (1777) and Yorktown (1781). The significance of Washington's role, British mistakes, and French and Spanish involvement in the war. • The Peace of Paris (1783), including the role of Franklin.
3 Consequences of the war in America	• The significance of American independence for slavery. • The consequences of the war for Indigenous peoples. • The impact of the war on Loyalists, including their resettlement in Nova Scotia and Niagara.